

Ethan W. Todd

✉ ewtodd@umich.edu • 🌐 ewtodd • 🆔 0009-0003-5162-9044

Education

University of Michigan

Candidate, Ph.D. Physics

Advisors: Prof. Igor Jovanovic, Prof. James Wells

2025 M.S. Physics

Winter

Ann Arbor, MI

2023 – Present (expected 2026)

Fall

Fall

Florida State University

B.S. Physics, Summa Cum Laude

Honors Thesis: Study of Displaced Vertex Tagging with the CMS Experiment

Advisor: Prof. Ted Kolberg

Tallahassee, FL

2020 – 2023

Fall

Spring

Emory University

Foundational Coursework

Atlanta, GA

2018 – 2020

Fall

Spring

Publications

5. V. Fondement, **E. Todd**, and I. Jovanovic, "Measurement of $^{78m}\text{Br } 2^- \rightarrow 1^+$ Transition Half-Life by Self-Coincidence Analysis in an Active Target $\text{LaBr}_3(\text{Ce})$ Detector," *under review*, 2026
4. **E. Todd**, V. Fondement, and I. Jovanovic, "Machine Learning-Enabled Pulse Shape Discrimination in YAP:Ce ," *under review*, 2026
3. C. Graham, **E. Todd**, C. Wilson, et al., "Light output-dependent integration gating for optimized pulse shape discrimination," *Nuclear Instruments and Methods in Physics Research Section A*, 2026. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.nima.2026.171521>
2. CMS HGCAL Collaboration, "Leakage current of high-fluence neutron-irradiated 8" silicon sensors for the CMS Endcap Calorimeter Upgrade," *under review*, 2025. [Online]. Available: <https://arxiv.org/abs/2510.17280>
1. K. Yocum, H. Smith, **E. Todd**, et al., "Millimeter/Submillimeter spectroscopic detection of desorbed ices: A new technique in laboratory astrochemistry," *The Journal of Physical Chemistry A*, 2019. DOI: [10.1021/acs.jpca.9b04587](https://doi.org/10.1021/acs.jpca.9b04587)

Research Experience

Applied Nuclear Science Group, University of Michigan

Graduate Student Researcher

Ann Arbor, MI

2024 – Present

Summer

Particle Identification in YAP:Ce via Machine Learning

- Compared α and γ -ray discrimination capabilities of charge comparison/shape indicator to several machine learning methods: random forests, gradient boosting, XGBoost, and multilayer perceptrons.
- Quantified the performance of each method using receiver operating characteristic curves, and demonstrated the substantial advantage of machine learning over traditional methods.
- Applied the XGBoost model to proof-of-concept mixed field radiation environments consisting of ^{241}Am and ^{137}Cs or ^{241}Am and ^{60}Co , and demonstrated that known spectral features of ^{241}Am , ^{137}Cs , and ^{60}Co are correctly classified.

Investigation of the Ionization Yield of Germanium at 254 eV_{nr}

Collaborator: Dr. Alexander Kavner, University of Zurich

- Jointly conducted an experimental campaign utilizing the spallation neutron source at the Paul Scherrer Institute to re-measure the energy of the final gamma-ray emitted in the $^{72}\text{Ge}(n, \gamma)^{73}\text{Ge}$ thermal neutron capture reaction, which is necessary to validate a recent ANSG measurement of the ionization yield of Ge.
- Utilized a **state-of-the-art, position sensitive CZT detector** to conduct precision measurements of the final state gamma-ray energy at the Ohio State Nuclear Reactor Laboratory thermal neutron beam facility.

Measurement of the $^{37}\text{Cl}(\alpha, n)^{40}\text{K}$ Cross Section

Collaborator: Dr. Daniel Santiago-Gonzalez, Argonne National Laboratory

- Currently working on using data from the Multi-Sampling Ionization Chamber (MUSIC) experiment at ANL to produce the first measurement of the $^{37}\text{Cl}(\alpha, n)^{40}\text{K}$ cross section.
- Validated stopping power tables for ^{37}Cl in helium gas up to 2.5 MeV/u by comparing results from LISE⁺⁺ and Geant4 calculations to calibrated measurements with a silicon diode.
- Developing an event reconstruction algorithm for MUSIC which performs offline time synchronization of four digitizers via analysis of the time structure of the ^{37}Cl beam.

CMS Group, Florida State University

Undergraduate Student Researcher

Tallahassee, FL

2021–2023

Fall Summer

Search for BSM Long-lived Particles

Advisor: Prof. Ted Kolberg

- Utilized deep neural network machine learning to search for beyond the Standard Model long-lived particles in data from the CMS Experiment.
- Trained ML models on Monte Carlo data with varying signal (mass, lifetime) and background (t , b physics) to verify their ability to identify displaced vertices independently of the particular physics.
- Investigated the most effective parameters of ML models and verified physics-based expectations.

Silicon Sensor Quality Control

Advisor: Prof. Rachel Yohay

- Conducted process quality control (PQC) testing for the CMS High Granularity Calorimeter (HGCal) to monitor the quality and stability of the silicon sensor production process.
- Analyzed and presented PQC results to the CMS HGCal sensor testing group.
- Helped create and implement a standardized testing procedure at FSU.

WW Astrochemistry Group, Emory University

Undergraduate Student Researcher

Atlanta, GA

2018–2020

Fall Fall

Advisor: Prof. Susanna Widicus Weaver

- Performed millimeter/submillimeter spectroscopic measurements of desorbed astrophysical ice analogs.
- Conducted proof-of-concept millimeter/submillimeter spectroscopic measurements of H_2O and D_2O binding energy, sublimation enthalpy, and sublimation entropy.

Teaching Experience

University of Michigan

Lead Graduate Student Instructor

Ann Arbor, MI

2025–2026

Fall Winter

- Oversee 30 graduate student instructors teaching general physics laboratories with a total enrollment of 1800 undergraduate students.
- Edit and maintain the laboratory manuals and Jupyter notebook worksheets used in the course.
- Manage the course information and organization via Canvas.
- Arbitrate student and graduate student instructor concerns.

University of Michigan

Graduate Student Instructor

Ann Arbor, MI

2023–2025

Fall Spring

- 2025 Spring Physics 251, Fundamental Physics for the Life Sciences II Lab
- 2024 Fall Physics 121, Physics for Architects Lab
- 2023 – 2024 Fall Winter Physics 241, General Physics II Lab

Florida State University

Physics Learning Assistant

Tallahassee, FL

2022

Spring

PHY 2049C, General Physics B

Honors and Awards

- 2026**: Rackham Outstanding Graduate Student Instructor Award *Awarded for demonstrating extraordinary dedication and excellence as a teacher.*
Winter
- 2023**: Phi Beta Kappa Society
Spring
- 2023**: Joseph Lanutti Undergraduate Research Award *Awarded for third place in the FSU physics departmental poster presentation contest.*
Spring
- 2022**: Evelyn and John Baugh Research Presentation Scholarship *Awarded to travel and present research at SESAPS.*
Fall
- 2022**: Anna Runyan Undergraduate Endowment *Awarded for outstanding academic success in physics.*
Spring

Grants

- 2025**: NSUF Rapid Turnaround Experiment Grant *Awarded to conduct precision measurements of Ge gamma-ray cascades at the Ohio State University Nuclear Reactor Laboratory.*
Fall
- 2025**: Rackham Graduate Student Research Grant *Awarded to conduct research at the Paul Scherrer Institute on the ionization yield of high-purity germanium detectors.*
Fall

Skills

Programming: C++, Python, Nix, C

Software:	Nuclear Measurements:	ROOT, Geant4, CoMPASS, wavedump, LISE⁺⁺ , SRIM
	Machine Learning:	Scikit-learn, XGBoost, Tensorflow
	Version Control:	Git, Nix Flakes
	Build Systems:	Nix , Make, CMake
	Scientific Presentation:	L^AT_EX /Beamer
	Firmware:	coreboot/edk2 , Chromium Embedded Controller

Hardware: CAEN digitizers, soldering, electronic testing equipment (*i.e.*, oscilloscopes)

Presentations

4. **E. Todd**, V. Fondement, and I. Jovanovic, "Particle Identification in Fast Inorganic Scintillators via Machine Learning," *Fall Meeting of the Eastern Great Lakes Section of the American Physical Society, Ypsilanti, MI*, 2025
3. **E. Todd** and I. Jovanovic, "Investigation of Anomalous High Ionization Produced by Low Energy Nuclear Recoils in Germanium (poster)," *DOE NNSA Office of Defense Nuclear Nonproliferation R&D University Program Review, Gainesville, FL*, 2025
2. **E. Todd**, A. A. Kadhim, N. Bower, et al., "Process Quality Control for HGCal at Florida State University (poster)," *89th Annual Meeting of the Southeastern Section of the American Physical Society, Oxford, MS*, 2022
1. **E. Todd**, K. Yocum, P. Gerakines, et al., "A Novel Use of Rotational Spectroscopy for Studying Characteristics of Desorbed Interstellar Ice Analogs (poster)," *Emory SURE 2019 Symposium, Atlanta, GA*, 2019